

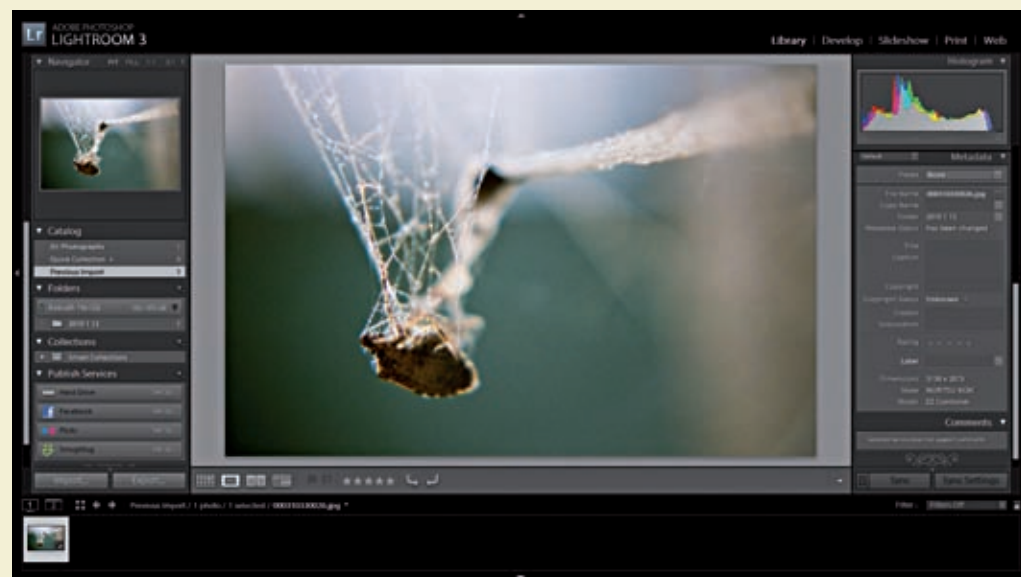
have decided that you prefer sticking with your previous OS for now, all you have to do is boot into the OS of your choice and delete the Windows 8 partition. In Windows 7, you press the Start button, search for disk management and delete the partition from there.

ADOBE LIGHTROOM 3.4.1

Adobe Lightroom is a very powerful software package designed for editing images. While not a photoshop replacement, this software houses all the essential tools that one would require for editing photographs.

Import images

Images in Lightroom cannot be opened directly. This is because Lightroom uses catalogues. It is a sort of database in which Lightroom stores all the information about what you're doing to the image. This is good as Lightroom will never touch your original image and will only make records in the database. The problem here is that if, for whatever reason, your database gets corrupted you'll lose all the additions you made to your image as well. Therefore, it's essential that you keep



Lightroom 3.4.1

regular backups of your Lightroom catalogues.

Bear in mind that whether you import one image or a thousand, Lightroom will always create a catalogue. By default, your catalogue is stored in the C:\User\Pictures\Lightroom\Lightroom 3 Catalog\ and has a .lrcat extension. Catalogue settings are available under Edit > Catalog settings ([Ctrl] + [Alt] +), and you can set personalised settings for each catalogue you use, including when to backup. Whenever you need an image for, say, posting online, make

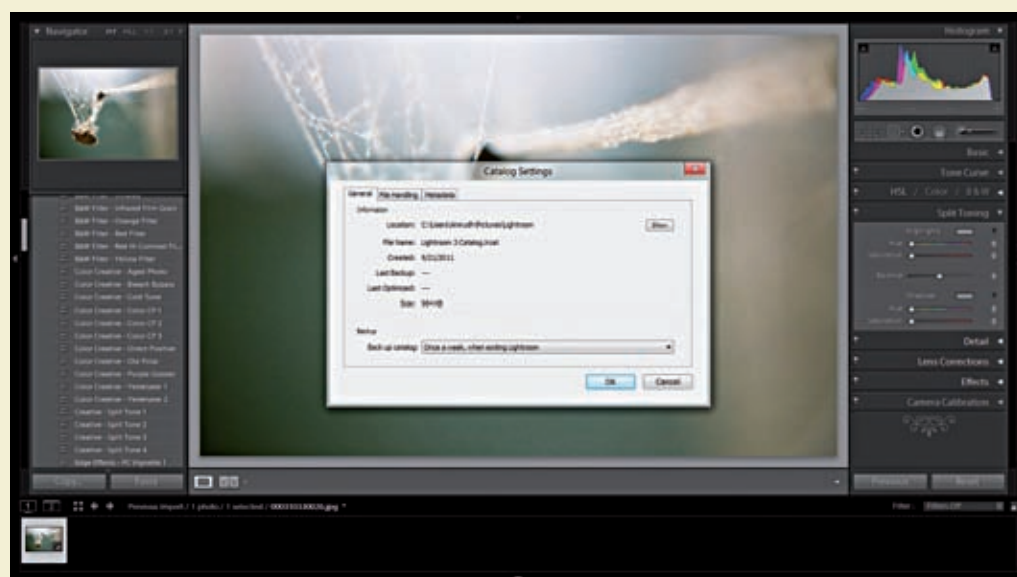
sure to export it from Lightroom and then upload the exported file because, as mentioned earlier, your original file is untouched.

Manage your photographs

To add multiple images from multiple locations to a collection, all you need to do is select the photos you want in your new collection, hit [Ctrl] + N, give the collection a name, and then include selected photos. This is very useful as it works as a virtual library, something akin to the library folder of Windows 7 where your selected files,

regardless of their location on the disk, will still appear in the collection of your choice.

Adobe Lightroom also includes a feature known as Smart Collections. What this does is, you select your criteria for images in that collection, say, a three-star rating, then, every image that you give three stars to will end up directly in that collection. To set up this criteria, hit the "+" button on the collection panel on the left and give the criteria of your choice. Some shortcut keys to note here are B to add images to a temporary collection and P to flag images for later.



Change catalog settings

Develop the images

Lightroom uses a .dng or Digital Negative format. The Develop tab is meant for "developing" this digital negative. This tab consists of a bunch of presets which can be used for directly applying effects to your image or images. The panel on the left side of the screen lists a whole pile of default presets. These are basically tweaks of white balance, contrast, colour temperature, etc. to produce a certain effect such as black and white, etc. Hovering over any of the presets will give you a preview of what that preset